What Bastaa costs to run, and what to charge

Internal guide for the owner. Only real running costs (cloud, SMS, services). Salaries and engineering time are left out on purpose. All figures are estimates in rupees per month, at ₹88 to the US dollar, checked on 25 October 2026.

₹11,175	₹2,100	₹3	₹10
Fixed cost a month, production setup, shared by all schools	Fixed cost a month, lean start, fine for the first 1 to 3 schools	Cost per student a month (₹36 a year), everything included	Suggested price per student a month (₹120 a year)

1. Fixed costs: what you pay every month, whatever the number of schools

These run the platform itself. One setup serves every school, so this bill is **shared**: the more schools, the smaller each school's part.

Service	₹ / month
Database (Cloud SQL Postgres, 1 vCPU, 3.75 GB, 20 GB SSD, daily backups, Mumbai)	₹5,700
API server, always on so the app never waits (Cloud Run, 1 vCPU, 1 GB)	₹4,200
Website server, office web app (Cloud Run, starts on demand)	₹800
Logs, secrets, app image storage	₹400
Domain bastaa.in (about ₹900 a year)	₹75
Cloudflare (DNS, SSL, CDN), push notifications (FCM), error alerts (Sentry free), email (Resend free, 3,000/month)	Free
Total, production setup	**₹11,175**

Lean start: about ₹2,100 a month. For your first 1 to 3 schools you can run a smaller database (db-f1-micro) and let the servers sleep when nobody is using them. The only catch: the first person after a quiet spell waits 2 to 3 seconds. Move to the production setup once a school is live and paying, or before the second school. Later, past about 10 schools or 10,000 students, expect the fixed bill to grow to around ₹25,000 (a standby database, a second server, paid email and error plans).

2. Cost per student: what each extra student adds

What it pays for	₹ / student / month
SMS: 4 per student a month (absence alerts, fee reminders, sign-in codes) at about ₹0.18 + 18% GST	₹0.85
Data sent to phones and browsers: about 100 MB per student a month	₹1.05
File storage: photos, homework images, PDFs (grows about 30 MB per student a year)	₹0.10
Extra server and database load as the school grows	₹0.40
Email: fee receipts and reports	₹0.10
AI features (report remarks, question papers): about ₹0.16 per request, 1 per student	₹0.15
Subtotal	₹2.65
Use this figure (with about 10% spare for surprises)	**₹3.00**

SMS is the cost to watch. Push notifications in the app are free, so SMS goes only to parents who don't use the app, or for urgent things. If a school wants SMS for every notice, sell extra SMS packs (page 2).

3. Your cost for one school, by size

Cost to you = ₹3 × students + that school's share of the ₹11,175 fixed bill. The share depends on how many schools you have, so here are three moments: your first school on the lean setup, 5 schools, and 15 schools.

Students	Per-student costs	First school (lean)	With 5 schools	With 15 schools	Per student a month (5 schools)
200	₹600	₹2,700	₹2,835	₹1,345	₹14.18
500	₹1,500	₹3,600	₹3,735	₹2,245	₹7.47
1,000	₹3,000	₹5,100	₹5,235	₹3,745	₹5.24
2,000	₹6,000	₹8,100	₹8,235	₹6,745	₹4.12
3,000	₹9,000	₹11,100	₹11,235	₹9,745	₹3.75

Small schools cost more per student because the fixed bill is split over fewer students. That is why the price below has a minimum.

4. Suggested price: fair, in line with the market, and safe for you

School ERPs in India are quoted at roughly ₹50 to ₹240 per student a year. Bastaa at ₹120 a year sits in the middle: not the cheapest, and not a price that scares a school away. You don't need to be the cheapest. You need every school to cover its own cost from day one.

Students	Price per student a month	In plain words
Up to 300	Minimum ₹3,000 a month	Covers a small school's cost even early on
First 1,000	₹10	₹120 a student a year
1,001 to 2,000	₹9 (only for these students)	Bigger schools get a little off
Above 2,000	₹8 (only for these students)	For large and multi-branch schools

Students	Price a month	Price a year (1 month free)	Your cost (5 schools)	You keep a month	Margin
200	₹3,000	₹33,000	₹2,835	₹165	6%
500	₹5,000	₹55,000	₹3,735	₹1,265	25%
1,000	₹10,000	₹1,10,000	₹5,235	₹4,765	48%
2,000	₹19,000	₹2,09,000	₹8,235	₹10,765	57%
3,000	₹27,000	₹2,97,000	₹11,235	₹15,765	58%

At 15 schools your cost per school drops by about ₹1,500 a month, so margins rise without changing the price. Keep the price steady; don't chase a big jump early. A modest, honest price wins more schools and keeps them.

5. Extras and one-time charges

Item	Charge the school	Your cost
Extra SMS (beyond 4 per student a month)	₹0.30 per SMS, sold in packs of 5,000	about ₹0.21
AI features (report-card remarks, question papers)	₹1,000 a month for 500 requests	about ₹80
Setup: data import, classes, fees, training call	₹5,000 one-time (waive it to close a deal)	your time only
School's own SMS sender name (e.g. DPSRNC)	School registers on DLT itself, about ₹5,900 one-time	nothing
Online fee payments (Razorpay)	About 2% + GST, taken by Razorpay from the school's account	nothing

6. Maintenance: what it means for the school and for you

For the school: there is no separate maintenance charge. The monthly fee already covers hosting, daily backups, updates and new features, security fixes and support. Say this clearly. Schools are used to a big upfront price plus a yearly AMC, and "nothing extra" is a selling point.

> **Don't sell a one-time licence.** Your servers and SMS cost money every month, forever. If a school insists on paying once a year, quote the yearly price (11 months). If they insist on "buy once + AMC", the yearly AMC must still be at least your yearly cost for that school plus 20%, e.g. for 500 students: ₹3,735 × 12 + 20% ≈ ₹54,000 a year AMC, on top of the one-time price.

For you: yearly and one-time running costs

Item	When	Cost
Domain bastaa.in renewal	Every year	about ₹900
Google Play developer account	One-time	$25 ≈ ₹2,200
DLT registration for Bastaa's SMS sender name	One-time (some operators renew yearly)	about ₹5,900
Apple developer account (only if you launch on iPhone)	Every year	$99 ≈ ₹8,700
Spare money for surprises (traffic spikes, price changes)	Keep aside every month	15% of the cloud bill
First year, lean start, one school with 500 students	12 months	about ₹43,000 + one-time ₹8,100

7. What to say when a school asks the price

- "It's ₹10 per student a month. For your 500 students that's ₹5,000 a month, or ₹55,000 if you pay for the year: one month free."
- "That covers everything: the office web app, the parent and teacher app, hosting, backups, updates and support. No maintenance charge, no extra per teacher or per parent."
- "SMS for absences and fee reminders is included. If you want SMS for every notice too, extra packs are ₹0.30 an SMS."
- "Online fee payment goes straight to your own bank account through Razorpay. We don't take a cut."
- "There's a one-time ₹5,000 setup where we bring in your students, fees and classes and train your staff." (Waive this if they hesitate.)

8. Where these numbers come from

- Google Cloud: Cloud Run instance billing about $0.000018 per vCPU-second and $0.000002 per GB-second, after the free tier. Cloud SQL for the Mumbai region is estimated at about 20% above the Iowa list price. Confirm in the Google Cloud pricing calculator before you sign the first contract.
- MSG91 transactional SMS: about ₹0.15 to ₹0.18 per message plus GST (third-party listings; get MSG91's rate card in writing). Failed deliveries are also charged.
- Gemini 2.5 Flash: $0.30 per million input tokens and $2.50 per million output tokens. A typical request (2,000 in, 500 out) is about ₹0.16.
- Resend email: free for 3,000 emails a month (100 a day), then $20 a month for 50,000. Sentry: free plan, then about $26 a month. Cloudflare and Firebase push: free at this size.
- Market prices: published school ERP prices in India range from about ₹50 to ₹240 per student a year (vendor listings, 2025 to 2026).
- Usage assumptions: 4 SMS and about 100 MB of data per student a month, with one school year of files kept. Real usage can differ; check your Google Cloud and MSG91 bills after the first two months and adjust.